OFFICE WORKPLACE

BASIC RISK ASSESSMENT GUIDE FOR ALL OFFICE PERSONNEL

This guide covers the main hazards you will face in the office workplace. **Read it. Know it. Follow it.**
If you are unsure about anything, **ask your Office Manager or Line Manager.**

#	HAZARD	WHAT CAN HAPPEN	WHAT YOU DO
1	**Screen and desk work (DSE)**	Eye strain, tired neck and shoulders, pain in wrists and arms (RSI).	✓ Take a break every 30 minutes ✓ Adjust your screen and desk height so your eyes are level with the top of the screen ✓ Keep your arms at 90 degrees when you type ✓ Rest your eyes and stretch your neck and shoulders
2	**Slips, trips, and falls**	You slip on a wet floor or trip over a cable. Broken bones, head injury, sprains.	✓ Keep the floor clear of obstructions and cables ✓ Wipe up spills straight away ✓ Wear flat shoes with good grip ✓ Report any trip hazards to your Office Manager
3	**Fire**	A fire starts from faulty wiring, the kitchen, or poor housekeeping. Everyone must evacuate.	✓ Know where the fire exits and assembly point are ✓ Know how to raise the alarm ✓ Never use lifts in a fire ✓ Help anyone who needs assistance to evacuate
4	**Electrical hazards**	Faulty wiring or overloaded sockets can cause electric shock or fire.	✓ Do not overload power sockets ✓ Report any damaged cables or plugs straight away ✓ Do not use electrical equipment if it looks damaged ✓ Do not use water near electrical equipment
5	**Manual handling**	Lifting heavy boxes or moving furniture can cause back pain or muscle strain.	✓ Bend your knees, not your back, when lifting ✓ Get help if something is heavy or awkward ✓ Use trolleys or equipment to move things ✓ Do not twist your back while holding something
6	**Workplace stress**	High workload, tight deadlines, or difficult relationships cause stress and anxiety.	✓ Tell your Line Manager if you feel overwhelmed ✓ Take your breaks and use your holiday ✓ Talk to a colleague or the Employee Assistance Programme ✓ Set boundaries between work and personal time

#	HAZARD	WHAT CAN HAPPEN	WHAT YOU DO
7	**Working at height**	Reaching high shelves or using a step ladder can cause falls and serious injury.	✓ Use a step ladder for anything above shoulder height ✓ Keep both feet on the step, never stand on the top ✓ Never lean to the side on a ladder ✓ Get help to reach high items safely
8	**Lone working**	Working alone outside normal hours means no one is there if you have an accident or medical emergency.	✓ Tell your Line Manager if you are working late ✓ Check in with a colleague before you leave the office ✓ Make sure your mobile phone is charged ✓ Know how to raise the alarm or call for help
9	**Visitors and security**	Unfamiliar people in the office could pose a threat to personnel or company data.	✓ Check ID before letting anyone into the office ✓ Do not share passwords or leave screens unattended with sensitive data ✓ Escort visitors to the meeting room ✓ Report any suspicious activity to your Office Manager
10	**Kitchen and welfare area hazards**	Hot water, kettles, and microwaves can cause scalds and burns.	✓ Wipe up spills around the kettle straight away ✓ Use a cloth when handling hot cups or containers ✓ Allow hot water to cool before drinking ✓ Check the microwave before opening it
11	**Heat stress (Dubai and Lagos)**	Extreme heat, especially when moving between air-conditioned and hot areas, causes fatigue and illness.	✓ Drink plenty of water throughout the day ✓ Take breaks in a cool area if you feel dizzy or unwell ✓ Wear light-coloured, loose clothing ✓ Tell your Line Manager if you feel unwell from the heat
12	**Road traffic and personal security (Lagos)**	Travel to and from the office, or in the city, carries risk of accident, armed robbery, or carjacking.	✓ Use the company driver or approved transport ✓ Keep doors locked while driving ✓ Avoid travelling alone, especially at night ✓ Tell your Office Manager if you feel unsafe

⛔ STOP WORK – YOU HAVE THE RIGHT

If you believe something in the office is not safe, you must report it and speak up.

No one will be punished for raising a safety concern. Tell your Office Manager or Line Manager. If they do not listen, contact the Group Compliance Director directly.

Full risk assessment: SM/HSE/RA/007 – Office Workplace v1.0
Related: Office H&S Policy | SM/HSE/PRO/001 – Hazard ID & Risk Assessment
Questions? Contact the Group Compliance Director or QHSE Manager

YOUR WATCH. OUR STANDARD.
Assess. Report. Deliver.